

The Practice of Climate Science

How is it studied?

- A branch of the earth sciences.
- A very complex dynamical system, with aspects of physics, chemistry, biology and a flavour unto itself.
- Study using:
 - ① General Circulation Models on large computers. Incorporate all of the 'microscopic' laws of nature we know. The computer model integrates this, in both time and in concept.
 - ② Theory, which might be mathematical models. Try to predict macroscopic behaviour ab initio.
- Test using observations (present and past): from daily tests (weather forecasts!) to paleorecords.

Aside: Observations are as important than ever, but that is another lecture.